Armor Operations

Quick briefing

Distinguish the roles of mechanized infantry, cavalry, and tanks and assess the conditions that enable or limit armored mobility.

Know the facts

Armor · A combined arms force designed for mounted combat using armor-protected vehicles as a principal means of accomplishing the mission.

Characteristics of armor · Protection, firepower, mobility, flexibility, intensive and flexible communications, and shock action.

Mechanized infantry · Combines a vehicle crew with a dismount team and can perform mounted or dismounted tasks according to mission and terrain.

Cavalry · Performs reconnaissance and surveillance and provides security, giving commanders information for decisions.

Tanks · Contribute protected mobility and firepower in a combined arms team and depend on support for sustained employment.

Mounted and dismounted employment · Mechanized infantry can operate with tanks when mounted and can work on terrain that requires movement on foot when dismounted.

Understand the reasoning

Nominal vehicle speed tells you little about the actual movement timeline if road access, bridge limits, or recovery support are unresolved.

Armor protection reduces exposure to some hazards. Planning still needs to consider terrain, communications, sustainment, and tasks that require people on foot.

Philippine Army classroom exercise

A Philippine Army classroom group is comparing vehicles for a training demonstration. A tracked option offers greater protection, while a lighter wheeled option has confirmed access to the approved venue. The course includes a task participants must perform on foot.

Decision · What information should drive the choice of platform for this demonstration?

Worked analysis · Start with the demonstration objective, then compare verified route access, available support, crew readiness, and how participants will perform the dismounted task. The lighter option fits a task that requires assured access if it can meet the learning objective. The tracked option may make sense if the exercise requires that capability and the venue can support it.

Check yourself

What is the cavalry's primary contribution in the lesson? · Reconnaissance, surveillance, and security.

Which teams make up a mechanized infantry squad in the lesson's model? · The carrier team and the dismount team.

Course source

Fundamentals of Armor Operations